

NATIONAL TEAM OF THE YEAR



Indian men's hockey team

Discipline: Hockey

The Indian men's hockey team backed up a successful 2023 by winning the bronze medal at the Paris Olympics. It was the first time in 52 years that India won back-to-back medals at the Olympics after clinching bronze in Tokyo three years earlier. India beat Australia in Olympic hockey for the first time in 52 years and followed it up with a thrilling penalty shootout win over Great Britain in the quarterfinals, despite being a man down for nearly 42 minutes. India fell agonisingly short of making the final, losing 2-3 in the semifinals to Germany. But it bounced back in the third-place match to beat Spain. India also successfully defended its Asian Champions Trophy crown by defeating host China 1-0 in the final.

Achievements in the 2024 season:

- ★ Won Olympic bronze medal in Paris
- ★ Successive Olympic medals for the first time in 52 years
- ★ Beat Australia in the Olympics for the first time in 52 years
- ★ Defended Asian Champions Trophy title in China



Indian women's table tennis team

Discipline: Table Tennis

The Indian women's table tennis team had a memorable 2024 season. The team comprising Manika Batra, Sreeja Akula, and Ayhika Mukherjee finished second behind China in its group at the World Team Championships in Busan in February. In its 2-3 group-stage loss to China, the team had two shocking wins as Ayhika beat World No. 1 Sun Yingsha while Sreeja upset World No. 2 Wang Yidi. The team eventually lost 1-3 to Chinese Taipei in the round of 16, but the result played a crucial role in its historic first-ever qualification for the Olympics. At the Paris Olympics, the

Indian team of Manika, Sreeja, and Archana Kamath reached the quarterfinals after beating Romania 3-2. The team - Manika, Sreeja, Ayhika, Diya Chitale, and Sutirtha Mukherjee - won its first-ever medal - a bronze - at the Asian Championships in Astana after beating South Korea 3-2 to reach the semifinals.

Achievements in the 2024 season:

- ★ Reached the round of 16 at the World Championships in Busan
- ★ Qualified for the team event at the Olympics for the first time
- ★ Reached the quarterfinals at the Paris Olympics
- ★ Won its first-ever medal - a bronze - at the Asian Championships